

2014).

[453](#) Even before there was a commercial aviation industry, the military kept records on aircraft accidents. Matthew Syed, *Black Box Thinking: Why Most People Never Learn from Their Mistakes—But Some Do* (Portfolio, 2015).

[454](#) Sarah Kliff, “Medical errors in America kill more people than AIDS or drug overdoses. Here’s why,” VOX (April 22, 2015). There are several studies of preventable, fatal medical errors and the results vary widely. The studies include: The American Institute of Medicine, which estimated the range at 44,000 to 99,000 a year; The Harvard study, which places the figure at more than 120,000; and *The Journal of Patient Safety*, which placed the figure at 400,000. Other deaths from improper care at nursing homes, pharmacies, outpatient clinics, and private offices could bring the figure to more than 500,000 a year.

[455](#) Sarah Klein and Douglas McCarthy, “A Conversation with Peter Pronovost About Patient Safety.”

[456](#)

The collapse of Bear Stearns eventually led me to write *Bailout Nation*. When Bear collapsed in March 2008, it wasn’t merely a harbinger of the coming financial crisis; it was a reminder that no company was immune from existential failure. Public companies are reluctant and often strongly resist attempts to document and openly assess their failures. Perhaps they are not the ideal model to look to when thinking about failure.

[457](#) Jeff Bezos, founder and chief executive officer of Amazon.com Inc., is one of the few executives who discusses failure openly. “To invent you have to experiment, and if you know in advance that it’s going to work, it’s not an experiment. ... Invention requires a long-term willingness to be misunderstood. Companies that don’t embrace failure and continue to experiment eventually get in the desperate position where the only thing they can do is make a Hail Mary bet at the end of their corporate existence.”

[458](#) Bloomberg Billionaires Index.

[459](#) “The 25 Most Important Private Companies,” *Fortune* (2017).